

Linux-based smartphone OS, Tizen, gets a new lease of life

If reports are to be believed, the Linux Foundation has breathed new life into the Linux-based smartphone OS, Tizen. According to a blog post, the Linux Foundation has released the source code and SDKs for the first alpha version of Tizen 2.0. This move has given rise to speculations about Samsung making a phone based on this platform.

Reportedly, Samsung is showing interest in Tizen as a possible alternative to Android.

According to sources, Samsung donated \$50,000 to the Linux Foundation, making it one of the seven corporate platinum members. The reason behind this move was unclear back then.

Earlier this month, the Wi-Fi Alliance published a document certifying that a Samsung handset named the 'GT-I9300_TIZEN' had passed its interoperability tests. The GT-I9300 is Samsung's internal model number for the Galaxy S III, prompting speculation that the company may be readying a version of that phone for Tizen.

The blog post that announced the release spoke about the new version of Tizen, which includes an improved Web framework offering better support for HTML5 and other Web standards, plus device APIs for handling file transfers, power control, and notifications. Accompanying the release is an IDE and SDK for developing Web applications to run on Tizen, plus a new SDK for native platform development.

This alpha release testifies to the fact that the platform, far from dying out, may actually come along with Samsung phones.

TIZEN

Samsung devices to get Jelly Bean update

Samsung smartphone users now have reason to cheer! The company has given the go-ahead for the naming of devices that will get an Android Jelly Bean a.k.a. Android 4.1 update. Check out the list of devices:

- Samsung Galaxy S II/ Samsung Galaxy S II LTE
- Samsung Galaxy Note
- Samsung Galaxy S Advance
- Samsung Galaxy Chat
- Samsung Galaxy Ace 2
- Samsung Galaxy Beam
- Samsung Galaxy Ace Plus
- Samsung Galaxy Mini 2
- Samsung Galaxy S Duos

With Samsung curbing prices on its devices, it remains to be seen whether this news will create a frenzy among gadget lovers.



Vellamo benchmarking app gets a revamp

As Qualcomm's Vellamo benchmarking tool gets updated to 2.0, testing your Android device will now be more fun. Giving a thorough update to its Vellamo benchmark, Qualcomm has added a number of new tests to provide results that represent real-life scenarios. And this also marks the first time that the company has added a video streaming test and built a version for Android on x86, which

Google's Code-In contest for students begins this November

In an effort to give a boost to open source software development, Google has announced its popular Code-In contest for pre-university students. Students in the age group of 13-17 years can participate in the contest, which begins from November 26 and will continue till mid-January next year. Twenty grand prize winners of the contest will make a trip to Google's campus in Mountain View and meet the company's employees. Each winner will be allowed to take one of their parents or legal guardians along with them for the trip.

According to the blog post from Google, students will be able to work with 10 open source companies on a variety of tasks. All of these have successfully served as mentoring organisations working with university students in Google's Summer of Code programme.

The kind of tasks students will be working on will fall into the following categories:

Code: Tasks related to writing or refactoring code.

Documentation/training: Tasks related to creating/editing documents and helping others learn more.

Outreach/research: Tasks related to community management, outreach/marketing, or studying problems and recommending solutions.

Quality assurance: Tasks related to testing and ensuring that code is of high quality.

User interface: Tasks related to user experience research or user interface design and interaction.